This document details India specific travel per diems and related expense guidelines and needs to be read in conjunction with TP Travel@COMPANY XX: Travel and Expense India Policy.

- The entire travel circular is based on “Ownership Culture”, however, there might be a situation where the employee must check with his/her manager if and how he/she can travel.

- We rely on the employees that they know what needs to be done, in line with COMPANY XX Culture of “Empowered People”. Managers and employees should serve as role models for the company’s strategic direction and ensure sustainable and efficient use of available resources.

Salient Features

A. General Guidelines

1. Travel & Hotel Booking: All booking for business purposes must be done booked through COMPANY XX Authorized booking channel. However, in exceptional cases, booking of hotels and flights can be done outside COMPANY XX approved booking channels in accordance with the below mentioned approval mechanism:

a. For Hotel Bookings: Prior Manager +1 Approval is required if Hotel costs exceed the city Hotel tariff limits applicable. For Hotel Bookings within city tariff limits – Manager approval is required.

b. Travel Bookings (Air travel): Outside of approved COMPANY XX Booking Channels require Manager+1 approval

For Direct Reports of Business Heads, Business Finance head and Other Function Heads, prior approval from Business Head/Business Finance Head/Function Head, as applicable, shall be required.

2. Class of Air travel: COMPANY XX’ general class of travel is economy class using the “Lowest Logical Airfare” available at time of booking. Senior Management positions may fly business class for flights with total flight time per direction of 6 hours or more. In case of hopping/via flights, the longest flight duration to determine the class of travel: Eg

In case of hopping/via flights, where one segment of travel is >= 6 hours and the other is <6 hours, business class may be availed as the longest flight duration is 6 hours. However, in case, both travel segments are <6 hours each, then business class shall not be applicable.

COMPANY XX travelers are expected to book their trips as early as possible; ideally this will be at least seven

(7) days in advance for domestic flights, and at least twenty-one (21) days in advance for all other flights

3. For domestic travel, the general class for railway travel is Second class, airconditioned. Recommended booking channel via TMC (offline), alternative a direct ticket booking is explicitly permitted.

4. Use of CORPORATE Corporate Card – All Air / Train ticket booking and Hotel expenses are to be settled by CORPORATE Corporate Card of the employee only. Employees are expected to settle Corporate Corporate Card balances on or before due date. COMPANY XX does not reimburse employees for any fees (such as card suspension or late payment) incurred through failure to follow the above requirements. In case of primary corporate card is not accepted, as an exception, a personal credit card may be used. In such situations, employee to document the same on Online Booking Tool while claiming reimbursement.

> As part of our ongoing commitment to ensuring secure and seamless travel booking experiences, it is mandatory that COMPANY XX employee must follow corporate credit card tokenization process to use Online Booking Tool for booking travel itineraries. This requirement is in accordance with the Reserve Bank of India's 2022 regulation, aimed at reducing online credit card fraud and enhancing consumer security

5. It is the responsibility of the employee and his manager to claim expenses in accordance to the policy. Any claims made by the employee, that is not within the policy principles and also not prediscussed and aligned with manager, is subject to recovery and also disciplinary action as decided from time to time.

6. It is the individual's responsibility to produce original evidence of expense claim documents to tax authorities as and when demanded. COMPANY XX shall not be held liable to such authorities for retrieval of records. Employees shall be required to maintain the documents for a period of 11 years in accordance with the provisions of the Income-tax Act, 1961

7. The In-company managers' single approval of the expense claim in the travel tool towards the end of the process shall serve to document authorization of the executed business trip, as well as recognition and approval of the expenses incurred including approval of exceptions to the Circular.

8. Respective Business management (Business CEO / CFO) shall be responsible for ensuring the implementation and adherence to TP Travel@COMPANY XX: Travel and Expense India and Domestic and International Travel India Guidelines.

B. Daily Allowances Guidelines for Business Travel – Domestic and International

1. Travellers shall be paid Daily Allowances on a per diem basis for covering meal expenses and other miscellaneous expenses (eg tips), Daily Allowances shall be of 2 types – Meal Allowances and Overnight Allowances.

2. Meal Allowances shall be payable to an employee, while on a business travel, in case the stay / accommodation is provided / reimbursed by the company. Overnight Allowances shall be payable to an employee, while on a business travel, in case the stay / accommodation is managed by the employee and not reimbursed by the company.

3. If the Employee has business meals with any person/s for breakfast, lunch or dinner in the course of business while on tour, s/he can claim the actual expenses incurred on such expenditure subject to approvals.

B.1 Guidelines on Daily Allowances

1. Meal / Daily allowances will be paid for all meals & miscellaneous expense. The reduction of any meal allowances will no longer be applicable.

2. On occasions, where COMPANY XX / any other third party is making arrangements/reimbursing separately for all meals - such as offsites, conferences and includes business meals with employees/external clients, per diem allowances cannot be claimed.

3. On the last day of a continuous tour, if the employee checks out of the Hotel / Guest House in the morning and returns to the base location after completion of her/his work later in the day, s/he would be eligible for allowances in line with “Meal Allowance” for that day. On the day of departure or arrival of a continuous trip, “Meal Allowance” shall be payable at 100% rate (For more travel more than 6 hours) and 50% rate for less than 6 hours. “Overnight Allowance” will not be applicable be applicable during travel and/or transit duration.

4. In case of one day business trip / Short trips, employee would be eligible for allowances in line with “Meal Allowance” for that day

5. Any tips paid during the course of the tour are covered in the daily allowances and no separate claims can be made on this account.

6. For the day of departure and on the day of arrival, allowance as applicable to the place from where the journey commences will be paid.

7. Start time of the tour to be considered by an employee as leaving time from place of work or residence, similarly arrival time from tour will be considered as reaching time at the place of work or residence.

B.2 Daily Allowances for Domestic Travel

1. The daily allowances (only for living) for employees while on travel are as under:

All Levels	INR 1,250	INR 2,500
Band / Level	Meal Allowance/ Rate (erstwhile per diem allowance)	Own Accommodation Allowance (erstwhile per diem allowance and Inclusive of Meal Allowance)

1. Meal Allowance of INR 1,250 shall be payable to you if the company is making hotel / stay arrangement for the employee during a business trip. Whereas in case of an employee making own stay arrangement during business travel shall be entitled to INR 2,500.

2. For Short Tours of less than one day, where overnight outstation stay is not involved, an employee will be eligible to 100 % of Meal Allowance, if s/he:

i. Leaves her/his place of work or residence for official business and returns to his/her place of work or residence on the same day. AND

ii. Visits to satellite towns or distant places of work or residence involving a minimum one-way travel of not less than 60 km from the place of work or residence. Any travel to his/her normal place of work or back which crosses the municipal limits will not be a short tour.

iii. In case of a short tour duration of less than 6 hours, 50% of Meal Allowance shall be payable.

B.3 Daily Allowances for International Travel

Applicable Daily allowances (for all meals & miscellaneous expenses) can be accessed here.

C. Other Guidelines for Domestic Travel

C.1 Hotel Accomodation – Domestic Travel

1. Guest Houses / Transit accommodation of ADMIN would be the First Priority for booking an accommodation. For bookings kindly reach on the below coordinates:

City	Email	Contact Number
New Delhi	COMPANY XX.in@COMPANY XX.com	+91 XXXXXXXXXXX

Bengaluru	XXXXX@COMPANY XX.com	+91 XXXXXXX

2. In case, Guest Houses / Transit accommodation of ADMIN TEAM are unavailable, travelers should book hotels at the lowest rate available within COMPANY XX-contracted hotels. These are identifiable by a green tick on the COMPANY XX booking tool, Online Booking Tool. Travellers are recommended to factor in the hotel's proximity to our office or meeting location to ensure efficiency in travel.
3. If lowest logical contracted room is unavailable (indicated by “Green Tick” on Online Booking Tool), travelers are advised to choose “next available room (NAR)” at COMPANY XX contracted room rates.

4. In case of non-availability of rooms within COMPANY XX contracted hotel rates, Non-Senior Management (NSM) travelers can use HOTEL BOOKING TOOL lowest logical rates on Online Booking Tool; for which below are the citywise limits :

Type of City / Cities	**Limit for Cities (excluding taxes)**
Metros +Top cities + Holiday destinations: (Mumbai,Pune,Kolkata,Bangalore, Hyderabad, Chennai, Delhi, Gurugram, Noida, Ahmedabad, Goa)	INR 7,000/-
Rest of the cities	INR 5,000/-

. Sr Management (SM)Travelers can book at actuals within reasonable limits

5. In case, due to business exigencies bookings are not available within the city-wise limits (in HOTEL BOOKING TOOL)– please pre-discuss with Manager before booking.

C.2 Business Advance - There will be no business advance given for Domestic Tours.

C.3 Official expenses on conveyance, postage & telephone expenses (if any) will be reimbursed at actuals.

C.4 Porterage Charges – Porterage charges are permitted for reimbursement only during train travel within reasonable limits.

C.5 As a normal process, Employees are expected to make use of calling-cabs / Taxis for travel to / from the airport. COMPANY XX Contracted cab options like BTRs (https://book.btr-ltd.in/Login) / Carz-on-rent /BluSmart etc will be available for limited use with prior approval (exceptions : Female employees/ Late night travel (before 0600 hours or after 2200 hours) or similar situations/ Sr. Management) as per Domestic and International Travel India Guidelines.

C.6 Use of own vehicle for official purpose :When an employee uses her/his own vehicle for official purpose, excluding coming to place of work and going back from the place work, s/he can claim reimbursement as mentioned below:

- 2-wheeler: INR 8.0/km
- 4-wheeler: INR 18.0/km

C.7 Effective 1st Jan 2023, only Local Conveyance expenses, can be claimed without supporting bills/receipts (if using Rickshaw, local taxis where bills are not provided). In this regard, please note that:

- Local Conveyance claims, at actuals, up to a maximum of INR 1,000 per claim can be approved by employee's Manager as per current process.

- In exceptional circumstances where local conveyance expense claim is higher than INR 1,000 per claim without supporting / bills, the employee mandatorily needs to attach approvals of employee's Manager + 1 along with clear justification for lack of supporting documents. Claims will be processed only with such approvals

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- No other expense types can be claimed without supporting bills.

C.8 Laundry Expenses, can be claimed on actuals and within reasonable limits in case of domestic travel exceeding 7 consecutive nights

C.9 Employees should prepare travel expense sheet immediately on return from their tour, in any case not later than 7-10 days through Online Booking Tool.

C.10 Employees will be able to book accommodation for personal trips at COMPANY XX approved rates in specified hotels. For all such bookings the employee will get in touch with the hotel directly. Such bookings can be done through the HOTEL BOOKING TOOL App however, CORPORATE corporate card cannot be used for such transactions.

D. Other Guidelines for International Travel

D.1 Hotel Accommodation – International Travel

COMPANY XX travellers should select the lowest possible price for hotels in regards to total cost considerations since accommodation cost will be paid at actual. The Online Booking Tool provides the traveller with negotiated preferred rates and conditions in COMPANY XX' primary and secondary locations globally as well as market rates to guarantee best availability and price.

D.2 Laundry Expenses, can be claimed on actuals and within reasonable limits in case of travel exceeding 7 consecutive nights

D.3 Business Advance: There will be no business advance given for International Tours. Corporate corporate card to shall be used for all oversees expenditure, Forex advance provided for overseas travel on work permit.

D.4 Forex: If there is a requirement for expenses to be managed at the destination, traveller can use their CORPORATE corporate card to withdraw foreign currency which is equivalent to 50,000 INR per trip in a month.

D.5 Official expenses on conveyance & telephone expenses (if any) will be reimbursed at actual. Employees who travel on International business tours must ensure activation of their International roaming (pre-paid or post-paid) to be eligible for mobile reimbursements (if any).

This document will replace all other previous notifications, schemes, policies communicated to employees on the subject. The Company's interpretation of the scheme and its applicability will prevail at all times.

CFO **CHO**